

AI Systems Client Intake Questionnaire

Website + CRM + Simple Agent + Follow-Up Agent + Alerts + Dashboard

Use this worksheet to gather the information needed to scope and build a practical AI-enabled business system. Rough answers are fine. The goal is to understand the business, the customer journey, the follow-up process, and what needs to show up on one simple dashboard.

Business / Company Name	
Primary Contact	
Email / Phone	
Website / Social Links	
Date Completed	

What this questionnaire is designed to scope

- A simple public website or landing page that explains the business and captures leads.
- A lightweight CRM pipeline for leads, customers, tasks, and follow-up status.
- A simple AI assistant/agent for FAQs, intake support, and basic customer guidance.
- A follow-up assistant that drafts emails, reminders, and next-step messages.
- Alerts for new leads, stale follow-ups, urgent messages, and status changes.
- One dashboard that shows the owner what matters without overcomplicating the system.

1. Business Basics

Start with the plain-English version of what the company does.

Question: What does your business do in one sentence?

Answer:

Question: Who are your main customers?

Answer:

Question: Where do you serve customers? Include cities, counties, states, or online-only areas.

Answer:

Question: What are your business hours and preferred response times?

Answer:

Question: Who on your team will use the system? Include roles, not just names.

Answer:

Question: What makes your business different from competitors?

Answer:

2. Business Goals

Define what a successful build should improve.

Question: What is the main outcome you want from this system? Examples: more leads, faster replies, fewer missed follow-ups, cleaner scheduling, better customer tracking, higher close rate.

Answer:

Question: What is currently costing you the most time, money, or missed opportunity?

Answer:

Question: What would make this project feel successful 30 days after launch?

Answer:

Question: What would make this project feel successful 90 days after launch?

Answer:

Question: What should this system absolutely not do?

Answer:

3. Current Website and Online Presence

Help us understand what exists now and what needs to change.

Question: Do you currently have a website? If yes, who hosts it and who can access it?

Answer:

Question: What pages do you currently have? Examples: Home, Services, About, Contact, Booking, FAQ, Products.

Answer:

Question: What pages do you need in the new or improved site?

Answer:

Question: What do customers usually look for when they visit your site?

Answer:

Question: What websites do you like the look and feel of? Include links if possible.

Answer:

Question: What tone should the site have? Examples: premium, friendly, local, technical, professional, bold, simple.

Answer:

4. Services, Products, and Offers

The system needs to know what the business sells and how to explain it.

Question: List your main services or products. Include pricing if public or allowed.

Answer:

Question: Which services/products are most profitable or highest priority?

Answer:

Question: Which services/products should be pushed less or hidden?

Answer:

Question: What questions do customers ask before buying or booking?

Answer:

Question: What objections or concerns do customers usually have?

Answer:

Question: What customer situations are a bad fit or should be disqualified?

Answer:

5. Lead Capture and Customer Intake

This is the core of the website, CRM, and follow-up system.

Question: Where do leads currently come from? Examples: website, phone, email, Instagram, Facebook, Google, referrals, marketplace platforms.

Answer:

Question: What information do you need from a new lead before you can help them?

Answer:

Question: What questions should the intake form ask?

Answer:

Question: What makes a lead high priority?

Answer:

Question: What makes a lead low priority?

Answer:

Question: What should happen immediately after someone fills out the form?

Answer:

6. CRM and Pipeline

Define the stages a lead or customer should move through.

Question: What tool do you currently use to track leads/customers? Examples: notebook, spreadsheet, Google Contacts, HubSpot, Shopify, Airtable, none.

Answer:

Question: What pipeline stages should exist? Example: New Lead, Contacted, Qualified, Proposal Sent, Scheduled, Won, Lost, Follow-Up Later.

Answer:

Question: What fields should be tracked for each lead/customer? Example: name, phone, email, source, service needed, budget, urgency, status, notes, next follow-up date.

Answer:

Question: Who should own or be assigned to each lead?

Answer:

Question: When should a lead be considered lost, inactive, or stale?

Answer:

Question: What reports or summaries would help you manage the business?

Answer:

7. Simple AI Assistant / Website Agent

This assistant should be useful, safe, and limited to the business context.

Question: What should the assistant help customers with? Examples: answer FAQs, explain services, collect intake information, route customers, suggest next steps.

Answer:

Question: What information should the assistant be allowed to answer from?

Answer:

Question: What should the assistant never say or promise?

Answer:

Question: When should the assistant stop and tell the customer a human will follow up?

Answer:

Question: What tone should the assistant use?

Answer:

Question: Should the assistant capture lead info, or only answer questions?

Answer:

8. Follow-Up Agent and Email Drafting

This is where the system helps the business stay responsive without sounding robotic.

Question: What follow-ups do you send today? Examples: new lead reply, appointment reminder, proposal follow-up, no-response follow-up, post-service check-in, review request.

Answer:

Question: What follow-ups should be drafted automatically but approved before sending?

Answer:

Question: What follow-ups should be sent automatically, if any?

Answer:

Question: How many follow-ups should happen before a lead is marked inactive?

Answer:

Question: What tone should follow-up messages have?

Answer:

Question: Do you have existing email or text templates we should use?

Answer:

9. Alerts and Notifications

Decide when the owner or team needs to know something happened.

Question: Who should be alerted when a new lead comes in?

Answer:

Question: What situations are urgent?

Answer:

Question: Where should alerts go? Examples: email, SMS, Slack, dashboard, phone notification.

Answer:

Question: How fast should urgent leads be handled?

Answer:

Question: What should count as a missed follow-up?

Answer:

Question: Do you want daily or weekly summary alerts?

Answer:

10. Dashboard

The dashboard should make the business easier to run, not add noise.

Question: What are the top 5 things you want to see when you open the dashboard?

Answer:

Question: What should be visible on the home screen? Examples: new leads, overdue follow-ups, active customers, revenue, appointments, tasks, message drafts.

Answer:

Question: Who needs access to the dashboard?

Answer:

Question: Should different people see different information?

Answer:

Question: What actions should be possible from the dashboard? Examples: approve draft, mark contacted, update status, add note, assign owner.

Answer:

Question: What information should never appear on the dashboard?

Answer:

11. Integrations and Tools

List the tools the system may need to connect with.

Question: What email system do you use? Examples: Gmail, Outlook, custom domain email.

Answer:

Question: What calendar or booking system do you use?

Answer:

Question: Do you use Shopify, Stripe, Square, QuickBooks, HubSpot, Airtable, Google Sheets, Zapier, Make, or n8n?

Answer:

Question: Do you want forms to save into a spreadsheet, CRM, dashboard, or all three?

Answer:

Question: Do you need payment links, invoices, or quotes?

Answer:

Question: Who can provide login access or API keys if needed?

Answer:

12. Brand, Content, and Assets

The build will be better if the business provides usable materials early.

Question: Do you have a logo, brand colors, photos, videos, brochures, or existing copy?

Answer:

Question: Do you have testimonials, reviews, case studies, before/after photos, or proof points?

Answer:

Question: What words should describe the brand?

Answer:

Question: What words should never describe the brand?

Answer:

Question: What competitors should we review?

Answer:

Question: Who must approve final website copy, emails, and dashboard wording?

Answer:

13. Privacy, Consent, and Risk

Keep the system practical and responsible.

Question: Will the system collect sensitive customer information? If yes, what kind?

Answer:

Question: Do customers need to agree to being contacted by email or SMS?

Answer:

Question: Do follow-up messages need unsubscribe language?

Answer:

Question: Are there industry rules, legal requirements, or licensing requirements we should know about?

Answer:

Question: Should any data be deleted after a certain period?

Answer:

Question: Who should be allowed to export customer data?

Answer:

14. Priorities, Timeline, and Budget

Separate launch needs from later improvements.

Question: What must be included in version 1?

Answer:

Question: What can wait until version 2?

Answer:

Question: What deadline are you trying to meet?

Answer:

Question: Do you prefer fastest working version, most polished version, or cheapest stable version?

Answer:

Question: What is the realistic budget range for version 1?

Answer:

Question: Who signs off before build starts?

Answer:

Automation Map

Use this page to capture the exact workflows that should be built or improved.

Trigger	Condition / Rule	Action	Owner / Notification
New website lead submitted			
Lead is high priority			
Lead has no response after 24 hours			
Appointment is booked			
Proposal is sent			
Customer completes service/order			
Customer leaves no review after service			
Other:			

Version 1 Scope Checklist

Mark what should be included in the first build.

☐	Public website / landing page	☐	Contact or intake form
☐	Simple CRM / lead pipeline	☐	Lead dashboard
☐	AI website assistant / FAQ agent	☐	Follow-up email drafting
☐	Automated lead alerts	☐	Appointment reminders
☐	Review request follow-up	☐	Shopify or ecommerce workflow
☐	Payment / quote workflow	☐	Weekly summary report
☐	Other:		

Client Signoff

Use this to confirm that the initial discovery form is complete enough to scope version 1.

Client Name	
Company	
Signature	
Date	
Notes / Approval Conditions	